CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 15

Hadley Cresswell

EDITOR OF THE HOLLOW GAZETTE



"Every story in the Hollow crosses your desk. Tonight's was meant to be an exclusive."

FOR HADLEY CRESSWELL'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

CORE CHARACTER

IN EVERY GAME

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A trench coat or long cardigan, a press card on a lanyard and a pencil behind your ear. Carry a small notebook.

Mask: a black half mask with PRESS written across the top in white.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

- **Before the ball:** read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.
- **Round 1:** the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.
- **Round 2:** the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.
- **Costume Parade:** strike a pose and stay in character.
- **Round 3:** page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

Print this booklet single-sided, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

BACKGROUND

Vesper promised you the story first, “after nine.” You have never been good at waiting.

YOUR SECRET

At 8:10 you slipped into Vesper’s study off the Lantern Gallery and read the notes for nine o’clock on the desk. They said the Hall goes to the town as a Lantern Museum, that the six brass candle molds in the display case are fakes, and that “whoever sold them has until nine to tell me.”

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

You heard the 8:15 toast. From 8:30 to 8:38 you stood at the ballroom end of the Lantern Gallery, writing in your notebook. Outside the windows, Perry was up a stepladder fiddling with a latch. At about 8:35 you saw someone in a long black cloak and a fox mask carry a steaming pumpkin cup from the Back Stairs end down to Vesper’s chair. Vesper said, “Oh, thank you.” The figure said nothing and walked back toward the Back Stairs. At 9:00 you and Darcy found Vesper.

YOUR GOALS

- Make sure everyone hears what you saw at 8:35.
- Keep your visit to the study quiet until Round 2.
- Get the real story for the Gazette.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

At about 8:35 you were at the ballroom end of the Lantern Gallery and saw someone in a long black cloak and a fox mask carry a steaming pumpkin cup from the Back Stairs end to Vesper's window chair. Vesper took it and said, "Oh, thank you." The figure said nothing and walked back toward the Back Stairs. Don't say why you were there.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Where were you at 8:35?"
- Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "What did Vesper say to you after the toast?"

YOUR TASK

> Interview three suspects for the Gazette and write down one quote from each.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

The Gazette's terrace camera took the photos in Evidence #6, one every six minutes. Admit that at 8:10 you slipped into Vesper's study and read the notes for nine o'clock: the Hall goes to the town as a Lantern Museum. Keep the rest of the notes to yourself for now.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- Ask **Perry Lanthorn:** "What were you holding on that stepladder?"
- Ask **Briar Fallow:** "Who was in the parade line-up the whole time?"

YOUR TASK

> Get one suspect to give you an "official statement" for the front page.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Now share the rest of Vesper's notes, which match Evidence #11: the six brass candle molds in the display case are fakes, an appraiser comes on November 1, and "whoever sold them has until nine to tell me." Whoever carried that cup at 8:35 walked like someone who knew the house.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Who in this house could tell a fake candle mold from a real one?"

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Did you wear your fox mask at all after 8:25?"

YOUR TASK

> Write tomorrow's Gazette headline on the back of your ballot.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

14 Jory Greaves · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion

15 Hadley Cresswell · Editor of the Hollow Gazette

16 Auden Pryor (OPT.) · Town historian and keeper of the Lantern Ghost legend

17 Bexley Applegate (OPT.) · Owner of the Applegate cider press

18 Corin Thimble (OPT.) · Fiddler and leader of the ball's band

19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade